

Texas MLO 5-Day Self-Paced Syllabus

Purpose

This syllabus turns the study materials in this folder into a disciplined five-day execution plan. It is designed for a Texas mortgage loan officer candidate preparing to pass the SAFE MLO exam with Uniform State Content while also learning how the work is performed inside a mortgage company.

This is not a light review plan. Each day has:

- Reading assignments.
- Flashcard targets.
- Math/timing drills.
- Field-practice exercises.
- Written recall work.
- Pass/fail checkpoints.
- A remediation plan if you miss the target.

Required Materials

Use these files in C:\Users\Mason\Documents\MLO :

- PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf
- PRINT_THIS_master_math_timing_manual.pdf
- PRINT_THIS_5_day_training_guide.pdf
- PRINT_THIS_flashcard_study_deck.pdf
- PRINT_THIS_math_timing_cheat_sheet.pdf
- PRINT_THIS_MLO_FLASHCARDS.pdf

Digital source files:

- texas_mlo_professional_operational_handbook_exam_manual.md
- texas_mlo_master_math_timing_manual.md
- texas_mlo_5_day_training_study_guide_chapters_1_6.md
- mortgage_loan_officer_texas_3_day_flashcards.md
- texas_mlo_math_timing_cheat_sheet.md

Daily Time Block

Recommended minimum:

- 4.5 to 6 focused hours per day.

Best structure:

- Block 1: Reading and annotation.
- Block 2: Active recall and flashcards.
- Block 3: Math/timing drills.
- Block 4: Scenario practice and field application.
- Block 5: End-of-day written checkpoint.

Rules:

- Do not study passively for more than 45 minutes without recall.
- Do not highlight without writing a question or example.
- Do not move to the next day with unresolved weak areas under 75%.
- Track missed concepts in a "miss log."

Miss Log Template

Date	Missed Concept	Why I Missed It	Correct Rule	Example	Retest Date

Use the miss log aggressively. The exam punishes repeated weak spots more than it punishes lack of motivation.

Day 1 - Role, Licensing, Texas Framework, and Exam Map

Objective

By the end of Day 1, you should understand what an MLO is legally allowed to do, how Texas licensing fits into the work, and how the exam is weighted. You should also understand that mortgage origination is not just sales; it is regulated consumer-credit work.

Primary Reading

Read from `PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf` :

- Part I - The Professional MLO Operating Model.
- Chapter 1 - What the Mortgage Loan Officer Is Paid to Do.
- Chapter 2 - Licensing, NMLS, Sponsorship, and Texas Agency Awareness.
- Appendix C - First 90-Day Professional Development Plan.
- Appendix J - Final Mastery Standards.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_5_day_training_guide.pdf` :

- Purpose.
- Five-Day Company Training Plan.
- Chapter 1 - The MLO Role, License, and Company Expectations.
- Chapter 4 - Texas and Uniform State Content.

Study Questions

Answer in writing:

1. What two activities generally define MLO activity?
2. Why does compensation or gain matter?
3. Why is job title less important than actual conduct?
4. What is the NMLS unique identifier?
5. What is sponsorship?
6. Why does passing the exam not automatically mean you can originate?
7. What is temporary authority?
8. What is the difference between state licensing and federal registration?
9. What Texas agencies should an MLO recognize?
10. Why is Texas home equity/homestead lending treated cautiously?

Flashcard Assignment

Use `PRINT_THIS_flashcard_study_deck.pdf` or `PRINT_THIS_MLO_FLASHCARDS.pdf` .

Study cards:

- 51-70: SAFE Act, licensing, Texas-specific focus.

- 131-135: exam weighting.
- 143: Texas licensing strategy.

Target:

- First pass: answer without notes.
- Second pass: repeat missed cards.
- Final pass: score at least 85%.

Field Practice

Write a clean borrower-facing explanation:

"What I can discuss before an application versus what happens once an application is taken."

Include:

- No guarantee of approval.
- Disclosure timing.
- Verification.
- Underwriting.
- Licensing boundaries.

Day 1 Drill

Create three short scenarios and answer whether the person is acting as an MLO:

1. A person collects borrower income and property information for a fee.
2. A processor gathers missing documents but does not offer terms.
3. A real estate agent suggests a lender but does not negotiate mortgage terms.

For each:

- Identify the activity.
- Identify whether compensation/gain exists.
- Decide whether licensing concern exists.

End-of-Day Checkpoint

Pass standard:

- You can define MLO activity from memory.
- You can explain active license and sponsorship.
- You can name SML and OCCC.
- You can recite the five NMLS content areas and weights.
- You score 85% or higher on assigned flashcards.

If below standard:

- Re-read Chapter 2.
 - Rewrite the MLO definition three times in your own words.
 - Create five licensing scenarios and answer them.
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Day 2 - Federal Mortgage Laws, Disclosures, and Timing

Objective

By the end of Day 2, you should understand the major federal laws tested on the exam and how they operate in real files. Your priority is not memorizing acronyms. Your priority is knowing what triggers a duty, what deadline applies, and what conduct is prohibited.

Primary Reading

Read from `PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf` :

- Part II - Federal Law as Operating Procedure.
- Chapter 3 - RESPA and Regulation X.
- Chapter 4 - TILA, Regulation Z, TRID, and Cost Disclosure.
- Chapter 5 - ECOA, Fair Lending, FCRA, HMDA, GLBA, UDAAP, and Advertising.
- Appendix F - Deep Exam Prep: Law-by-Law Operational Questions.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_master_math_timing_manual.pdf` :

- Part 2 - Business Day Rules and Date Counting.
- Part 3 - Master Timing and Letter Deadline Chart.
- Part 4 - Date Counting Examples.
- Part 5 - Letters and Notices: What They Are For.
- Part 6 - Tolerance Buckets and Fee Changes.

Must-Know Federal Law Map

Create a handwritten table:

Law	Regulation	Main Purpose	MLO Risk
RESPA	Reg X	Settlement costs/kickbacks/escrow/servicing	Referral fees, escrow, servicing transfer
TILA	Reg Z	Credit cost disclosure	APR, rescission, TRID, LO comp
ECOA	Reg B	Fair lending	Discrimination, adverse action
FCRA		Consumer reports	Credit authorization, adverse action
HMDA	Reg C	Mortgage data reporting	Monitoring information
GLBA		Privacy	Borrower data security
UDAAP		Unfair/deceptive/abusive acts	Misleading claims

Flashcard Assignment

Study cards:

- 1-50: federal laws.
- 136-142: final review law strategy.
- 148-149: fee changes and Loan Estimate timing.

Target:

- 90% on timing cards.
- 85% on all federal law cards.

Timing Drill

Write answers without notes first, then check the master manual:

1. Six TRID application items are received Monday. When is the Loan Estimate due?
2. Six TRID application items are received Friday. Creditor open Monday-Friday. When is the Loan Estimate due?
3. CD is received Tuesday. No holidays. Earliest consummation?
4. CD is mailed Tuesday with no evidence of earlier receipt. When is deemed receipt?
5. Principal dwelling refinance closes Friday. Correct rescission notice given Friday. No holidays. When does rescission expire?
6. Completed application received May 1. When is ECOA action-taken notice generally due?
7. Servicing transfers effective July 1. When does old servicer generally send notice?
8. Mortgage ownership transfers April 10. When is ownership transfer disclosure due?

RESPA / Referral Practice

Answer each:

1. Title company offers \$100 per closed referral.
2. Realtor asks you to sponsor an open house at inflated cost.
3. You refer borrower to an affiliated title company.
4. A settlement provider pays for actual services at fair market value.

For each:

- Identify the RESPA risk.
- Decide whether disclosure, refusal, or compliance review is needed.

Day 2 Written Recall

From memory, write:

- Six TRID application items.
- Three CD restart events.
- ECOA protected classes.
- RESPA Section 8 rule.
- Difference between general business day and specific business day.
- Difference between servicing transfer and ownership transfer.

End-of-Day Checkpoint

Pass standard:

- You can count LE, CD, rescission, ECOA, escrow, servicing, and ownership transfer deadlines.
- You can explain RESPA Section 8 without notes.
- You can identify ECOA protected classes.
- You can explain why an LE cannot be delayed for bank statements.
- You score 85% or higher on federal flashcards.

If below standard:

- Re-read Master Timing Chart.
 - Redo all timing drills.
 - Build 10 new date-counting examples.
-

Day 3 - Products, Borrower Qualification, Underwriting, and Documentation

Objective

By the end of Day 3, you should understand the major mortgage products and the practical logic of underwriting. You should know how income, assets, credit, collateral, occupancy, and documentation fit together.

Primary Reading

Read from `PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf` :

- Part III - Products, Underwriting, and File Execution.
- Chapter 6 - Product Knowledge and Suitability.
- Chapter 7 - The Mortgage File From Lead to Funding.
- Chapter 8 - Underwriting Logic and Documentation Discipline.
- Appendix D - Operational SOP Library.
- Appendix E - Document and Red Flag Matrix.
- Appendix H - Operational Case Studies.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_5_day_training_guide.pdf` :

- Chapter 3 - General Mortgage Knowledge and Loan Products.
- Chapter 5 - Loan Origination Workflow, File Quality, and Calculations.

Product Comparison Work

Create a table:

Product	Best Fit	Main Strength	Main Risk	Documentation Concern
Conventional				
FHA				
VA				
USDA				
Jumbo				
ARM				
HELOC/Home Equity				

Do not write generic answers. Include real borrower examples.

Flashcard Assignment

Study cards:

- 71-90: mortgage products and terms.
- 91-100: origination workflow.
- 144-145: product and fraud strategy.

Target:

- 85% or higher.

File Quality Drill

Build a mock borrower file summary:

Borrower:

- Annual salary: \$92,000.
- Overtime: variable.
- Credit score: 694.
- Car loan: \$520.
- Credit cards: \$185.
- Student loan: \$300.
- Down payment funds: \$18,000.
- Gift funds expected: \$7,000.
- Purchase price: \$325,000.
- Primary residence.
- Closing in 24 days.

Answer:

1. What documents do you need?
2. What income questions must be answered?
3. What asset questions must be answered?
4. What product options might be considered?
5. What red flags or weak spots exist?
6. What should you avoid promising?

Underwriting Logic Drill

For each file factor, write what underwriting is trying to prove:

- Pay stubs.
- Bank statements.
- Credit report.
- Appraisal.
- Title report.
- Purchase contract.
- Homeowners insurance.
- Gift letter.
- Verification of employment.

Field Scripts

Practice out loud:

1. Explaining why all bank statement pages are needed.
2. Explaining why a preapproval is not a final approval.
3. Explaining why a low appraisal changes the file.
4. Explaining why occupancy must be accurate.

End-of-Day Checkpoint

Pass standard:

- You can compare FHA, VA, USDA, conventional, jumbo, ARM, and HELOC.
- You can explain the loan life cycle.
- You can identify documentation needs for income, assets, credit, and property.

- You can identify at least 10 red flags.
- You score 85% or higher on product/workflow flashcards.

If below standard:

- Re-read Appendix E.
- Build three more mock files.
- Explain each product to a beginner in two minutes.

Day 4 - Math, Equations, Timing Mastery, and Operational Execution

Objective

By the end of Day 4, you should be able to handle the math portion quickly and accurately. You should also be able to calculate deadlines and recognize which letters/disclosures are required.

Primary Reading

Read from `PRINT_THIS_master_math_timing_manual.pdf` :

- Part 1 - Master Math System.
- Part 2 - Business Day Rules and Date Counting.
- Part 3 - Master Timing and Letter Deadline Chart.
- Part 9 - Exam Attack Sheets.
- Part 10 - Advanced Practice Scenarios.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_math_timing_cheat_sheet.pdf` :

- Entire document.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf` :

- Chapter 9 - Mortgage Math as an Operating Skill.
- Chapter 10 - Timing, Letters, Disclosures, and Deadline Control.

Formula Memory Work

Write these from memory three times:

- LTV.
- CLTV.
- HCLTV.
- Down payment.
- Equity.
- Front-end ratio.
- Back-end DTI.
- Annual income to monthly.
- Hourly income to monthly.
- Biweekly income to monthly.
- Semimonthly income to monthly.
- Discount points.
- Daily interest.
- Monthly escrow.

- Escrow cushion.
- ARM fully indexed rate.
- Break-even on points.

Math Drill Set

Complete without notes first.

1. Loan amount \$280,000, value \$350,000. LTV?
2. Purchase price \$420,000, appraised value \$405,000, loan amount \$384,750. LTV using lower value?
3. First lien \$300,000, second lien \$45,000, value \$450,000. CLTV?
4. First lien \$300,000, HELOC limit \$75,000, value \$450,000. HCLTV?
5. Annual income \$108,000. Monthly income?
6. Hourly pay \$31.50, 40 hours/week. Monthly income?
7. Biweekly gross \$2,850. Monthly income?
8. Semimonthly gross \$3,900. Monthly income?
9. Housing payment \$2,850, gross monthly income \$9,500. Front-end ratio?
10. Housing \$2,850, other debts \$1,025, gross monthly income \$9,500. Back-end DTI?
11. Loan amount \$360,000, 1.25 points. Cost?
12. Points cost \$4,500, monthly savings \$125. Break-even?
13. Annual taxes \$7,800, annual insurance \$2,100. Monthly escrow?
14. Annual escrow disbursements \$9,900. Maximum cushion?
15. Loan amount \$390,000, rate 6.75%, 11 days prepaid interest. Approximate prepaid interest?
16. Index 4.50%, margin 2.25%. Fully indexed rate?
17. Start rate 5.75%, lifetime cap 5%. Lifetime max?
18. Purchase price \$375,000, loan amount \$337,500. Down payment and down payment percentage?
19. Value \$500,000, liens \$365,000. Equity?
20. Seller concession limit 3%, purchase price \$425,000. Maximum concession?

Target:

- 18 out of 20 correct.

Timing Drill Set

Complete without notes first.

1. Application received Monday. LE due?
2. Application received Thursday, creditor open Monday-Friday, Monday holiday. LE due?
3. CD received Monday, no holidays. Earliest consummation?
4. CD received Friday, no holidays. Earliest consummation?
5. CD mailed Monday with no evidence of earlier receipt. Deemed received?
6. Principal dwelling refinance closes Tuesday, rescission notice delivered Tuesday, no holidays. Rescission expires?
7. Principal dwelling refinance closes Friday, no holidays. Rescission expires?
8. Completed application received March 3. ECOA action-taken notice generally due?
9. Counteroffer sent April 1 and not accepted. ECOA follow-up deadline?
10. Initial escrow statement not given at settlement. Latest general deadline?
11. Annual escrow computation year ends June 30. Annual statement due?
12. Escrow surplus is \$85 and borrower current. Refund timing?
13. Servicing transfer effective September 1. Old servicer notice timing?
14. Servicing transfer effective September 1. New servicer notice timing?
15. Mortgage ownership transfers October 10. Ownership disclosure deadline?

Target:

- 13 out of 15 correct.

Operational Execution Drill

Write a one-page file timeline from application to funding. Include:

- Application trigger.
- LE.
- Intent to proceed.
- Document collection.
- Processing.
- Underwriting.
- Conditions.
- CD.
- Closing.
- Rescission if applicable.
- Funding.

End-of-Day Checkpoint

Pass standard:

- 90% on formula recall.
- 18/20 math drill.
- 13/15 timing drill.
- You can explain every missed answer.

If below standard:

- Do not move forward until you redo missed formula category.
 - Create five new problems for each weak formula.
 - Recount all missed timing questions using a calendar.
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Day 5 - Ethics, Fraud, Mixed Exam Simulation, and Final Readiness

Objective

By the end of Day 5, you should be able to apply the rules under exam pressure. You should also know how to behave in the field when borrowers, agents, referral partners, or internal pressure push you toward shortcuts.

Primary Reading

Read from `PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf` :

- Part V - Ethics, Fraud, and Professional Conduct.
- Chapter 11 - Ethics Under Pressure.
- Part VI - Exam Preparation Integrated With Operations.
- Chapter 12 - How the SAFE Exam Thinks.
- Appendix G - Borrower Communication Playbook.
- Appendix I - Trainer-Led Five-Day Intensive Agenda.
- Appendix J - Final Mastery Standards.

Read from `PRINT_THIS_5_day_training_guide.pdf` :

- Chapter 6 - Ethics, Fraud, Professionalism, and Field Survival.

- Trainee Workbook and Mentor Checkpoints.

Flashcard Assignment

Study cards:

- 101-130: calculations, ethics, fraud, prohibited conduct.
- 131-150: mixed final review.

Target:

- 90% or higher on ethics/fraud.
- 85% or higher on mixed review.

Ethics Scenario Drill

Answer each in writing:

1. Borrower asks you to omit a debt not on credit.
2. Borrower sends a bank statement that appears altered.
3. Agent asks you to guarantee closing in 10 days.
4. Title company offers sports tickets for referrals.
5. Borrower claims primary residence but facts suggest investment use.
6. Appraiser comes in low and listing agent asks you to pressure them.
7. Borrower wants you to use public assistance income, and another MLO says it should not count.
8. Borrower asks to send documents through personal text because it is easier.
9. Referral partner asks for a marketing arrangement far above fair market value.
10. Borrower asks if they can change income because "that is what I really make in cash."

For each:

- Identify the risk.
- State the correct action.
- Write the borrower/partner-facing script.

Mixed Exam Simulation

Build a 75-question self-test:

- 18 federal law questions.
- 8 Uniform State/Texas questions.
- 15 general mortgage knowledge questions.
- 20 origination workflow questions.
- 14 ethics questions.

Use:

- Flashcards.
- Manual scenarios.
- Timing drills.
- Math drills.
- End-of-chapter recall questions.

Target:

- 80% minimum.
- 85% preferred.

Final Written Recall

Without notes, write:

1. NMLS exam content areas and weights.
2. MLO activity definition.
3. Six TRID application items.
4. LE timing.
5. CD timing.
6. Three CD restart events.
7. ECOA protected classes.
8. ECOA 30-day and 90-day rules.
9. RESPA Section 8 rule.
10. Rescission rule.
11. Servicing transfer timing.
12. Ownership transfer timing.
13. LTV formula.
14. CLTV formula.
15. Back-end DTI formula.
16. Points formula.
17. Daily interest formula.
18. Texas SML/OCCC distinction.
19. Texas one-off origination warning.
20. Top 10 fraud red flags.

Final Night Plan

Do:

- Review miss log.
- Review cheat sheet.
- Review missed flashcards only.
- Review formulas and deadline table.
- Sleep.

Do not:

- Start new material.
- Watch random videos that contradict official materials.
- Cram until you are exhausted.
- Keep retesting what you already know while ignoring weak areas.

End-of-Day Checkpoint

You are exam-ready if:

- You score at least 80% on the mixed simulation.
 - You can explain every math formula.
 - You can count LE/CD/rescission/ECOA deadlines.
 - You can identify illegal referral compensation.
 - You can answer ethics questions with consumer-protective, documented, compliant actions.
 - Your miss log has no repeated unresolved concept.
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Full 5-Day Tracking Sheet

Day	Focus	Required Score	Actual Score	Cleared?
1	Licensing, role, Texas, exam map	85% flashcards		
2	Federal laws and timing	85% law / 90% timing		
3	Products and underwriting	85% flashcards		
4	Math and timing	18/20 math, 13/15 timing		
5	Ethics and mixed simulation	80% minimum		

What to Print

Print these first:

1. [PRINT_THIS_math_timing_cheat_sheet.pdf](#)
2. [PRINT_THIS_MLO_FLASHCARDS.pdf](#)
3. [PRINT_THIS_professional_handbook.pdf](#)
4. [PRINT_THIS_master_math_timing_manual.pdf](#)
5. [PRINT_THIS_5_day_training_guide.pdf](#)

Optional:

- [PRINT_THIS_flashcard_study_deck.pdf](#) if you prefer a study-deck format instead of cut-out flashcards.

Final Standard

The purpose of this syllabus is not to make you feel busy. The purpose is to produce measurable readiness.

You should finish each day with written proof:

- What you read.
- What you drilled.
- What you missed.
- What you corrected.
- What you can now explain without notes.

That is the difference between studying and training.